

Michaylia Stephenson

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Profile

Software Engineering student on track for a 2.1, with 1 year of placement experience building business-facing webpages and contributing to cross-functional technology projects at Zenith. Skilled in JavaScript, React, Python, and full-stack development through academic projects and independent work.

Skills HTML-CSS-Javascript-React-GSAP-Razor-Python-C#-.NET Framework- Dart-Java-Devops

Relevant Experience

Zenith	Software Engineering Industrial Placement Student	2025 - 2026
- Contributed to cross-functional working sessions, translating ideas into actionable proposals while collaborating effectively with different teams. - Implemented full-stack, database-integrated features across 5+ client-facing Commercial webpages, contributing 30,000+ lines of net code change while supporting new business functionality, adapting to different applications and team environments. - Applied software engineering principles throughout 12 months of development, using C#, React and SQL to improve code quality, debugging, innovation and critical thinking. - Set and managed achievable daily goals, completing 50+ work items during my placement through effective planning, time management and self-directed working.		

Education

University of Portsmouth	BSc Software Engineering (Hons) with optional placement	2023 - 2027
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Modules:

Database Principles

- Operated as a group member to implement a comprehensive database using **SQL**.
- Created complex queries to find relevant data, refining data analysis and analytical thinking skills,

Software Engineering Theory and Practice

- Participated in a team to develop a study application,
- Utilised **JavaScript, HTML, CSS, and Node.js**, focusing on front-end development and independently enhancing my skills through online tutorials and resources, fostering a deeper understanding of programming principles and my desire to learn.
- Engaged with team members to discuss front-end strategies, improving teamwork and communication.

Ethical Hacking

- Learned the ethical hacker mindset/toolkit to discover vulnerabilities by evaluating insider threats, exploiting weaknesses, and footprinting networks.
- Practised penetration testing skills on the **Linux operating system**, learning valuable knowledge about conducting security research.

Other Modules: Usability Engineering, Data Structures and Algorithms, and Web Programming.

Course Representative

2024 - 2025

- Collaborated with faculty to address and resolve common academic challenges, promoting a supportive learning environment.
- Served as the primary point of contact between students and faculty, effectively communicating course-related feedback and concerns.

A Level - Computer Science, Maths, Drama 2021 - 2023

GCSE - 9 GCSE's achieved, including English, Maths, Science, Computer Science - Grade 6-8 2019 - 2021

Projects

Concert Tracker Independent Project

Built a Blazor Hybrid (.NET MAUI) app that lets users use its 3 core features to track concerts, rate events, and store data locally. Integrated a city autocomplete API and implemented automatic date-based categorisation (Upcoming/Attended). Designed the full stack — UI, API integration, database schema, and state management.

RaceControl Second Year Web Programming Project | Grade 65%

Built a Node.js race timing app that tracks 100s of competitors in real-time even in aeroplane mode. Implemented 4 core features, including offline local storage, real-time competitor tracking, CSV result exports and automatic data synchronisation when connectivity was restored.

Work Experience)

Apple Store - Retail Specialist 2024 - 2025, 2026

- Connected with 20-30+ customers per shift, providing personalised product recommendations and

demonstrating Apple's innovative technology whilst delivering excellent customer service.

- Completed 50+ hours of extensive training on Apple's culture and product ecosystem, developing strong product knowledge and technology awareness to support and educate customers.
- Supported product launches in a fast-paced retail environment, leveraging product expertise to contribute to team goals and deliver results-oriented customer experiences.

Adidas Outlet - Store Sales Consultant

2025

- Maintained high visual merchandising standards through attentive organisation and efficient presentation of clothing and merchandise.
- Interacted with customers and offered personal recommendations for various products.
- Completed training on the till system.

The University of Portsmouth - Clearing Assistant

2024

- Provided real-time advice and support to prospective students during Clearing, delivering effective customer service and communication in a fast-paced environment.
- Processed 50+ applications and assessed student eligibility, demonstrating accuracy, organisation and the ability to work effectively under pressure.

Parmar Shoes - Retail Assistant/Manager

2021 - 2023

- Managed inventory deliveries and organisation while providing hands-on customer service and accurately processing payments.
- Trusted as primary key holder, independently completing end-of-shift procedures and ensuring the shop was prepared for opening
- Served 50+ customers per shift during peak periods, multitasking between personalised recommendations and stock retrieval while maintaining efficient customer service.

Volunteering)

2020 - Present

Jack Petchey Foundation - Speak Out Challenge Finalist & YCP Co-Lead/Youth Consultation Panel Member

- Confident communication skills, enabling 1st and 3rd place positions in the 'Speak Out' Challenge (public speaking). This drove me to join the 'Achievers Network'.
- Achieved Young Leader status and served as a positive role model for new members, guiding them through the process to become official members, leading me to become a Youth Panel member.
- Consulted with a team to aid in the creation and design of various grant programs and played a critical role in delegating the funding of the most relevant and effective programs.
- Co-led the Young Consultants Programme (YCP) by reviewing, developing, and assessing 10+ grant proposals, using strategic planning and effective communication to support funding decisions and negotiate with the board of trustees.

Oxfam - Retail Assistant

2021 - 2023

- Accomplished training on the till system, demonstrating proficiency in handling payments and managing customer transactions.
- Demonstrated organisation and time management skills as well as creativity.
- Steamed and arranged clothing items to maintain a visually appealing store environment.

Duke Of Edinburgh Silver and Bronze

2018-2020

- Periods spent accruing a variety of challenges to evolve physical and personal skills (for a minimum of an hour a week), along with six months of volunteering.
- Teamworking skills required to complete an expedition to demonstrate commitment and resilience by navigating and camping in the outdoors. Leadership skills evolved through managing our route and handling dispute resolution amongst team members.
- Independently planned and navigated a route from scratch during the Silver level, demonstrating strategic planning, problem-solving, perseverance and resilience while successfully completing the expedition.

Hobbies and Interests)

Portsmouth University Cheerleading - Game Day/Development Team Member (Flyer)

2023-2025

- Performed as a flyer on the gameday/development team, training twice weekly to master stunts and energetic choreography performed at sports games and annual varsity competitions.
- Executed technically demanding stunts requiring strength, balance, coordination, and trust while boosting social skills, contributing to team morale and school spirit.

National Youth Theatre - Summer Course Participant

2024

- Successfully auditioned for a highly competitive spot at the National Youth Theatre, completing their summer course.
- Matured essential skills in movement, voice and speech modification, comedy, and scriptwriting whilst connecting with fellow aspiring actors, expanding my network within the industry.